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THIS ISSUE IS DEDICATED IN HONOR OF THE FAST RECOVERY OF **דניאל בן מרים**

BS"D
Issue #246
SEPTEMBER 4, 2026
FRIDAY, 22 ELUL, 5786

COMMUNITY CORNER PARSHAS NITZAVIM-VAYEILECH נצבים-וילך



SHABBOS STARTS:

7:05 PM
(18 MINUTES)

SHABBOS ENDS:

8:12 PM
(50 MINUTES)

TZAIS HAKOCHAVIM:

8:35 PM
(72 MINUTES)

Editor-in-chief: Doni Stern

Made possible by contributing writers throughout our community.

STORY OF THE WEEK By: Zechariah Lipitz

In the little town of Lubavitch, the setting sun signaled the beginning of a new year. Many thousands of Chasidim poured into the town, eager to spend Rosh Hashana with the Tzemach Tzedek, Rabbi Menachem Mendel, the third Rebbe of Chabad-Lubavitch. They crammed into the Rebbe's shul. A hush fell on the room as the Tzemach Tzedek entered. A path miraculously appeared; the Rebbe made his way to his place, and Maariv, the evening service, began. It was an unusual Maariv. The Tzemach Tzedek appeared drawn, worried. His prayers were imbued with extraordinary fervor, as though - if it were possible - they were more fervent than an ordinary Rosh Hashana. Fear and dread gripped every heart. The Chasidim redoubled their concentration, desperately trying to arouse Divine mercy. Everyone felt that something unusual was in the air. That night after the prayers, the Rebbe joined his family in the holiday meal. Though it is customary to minimize all idle talk on Rosh Hashana, the Tzemach Tzedek made it a point to speak during the meal. He discussed current events in the capital, the names and ranks of different ministers and the political situation in general. Reb Yehuda Leib, one of the Rebbe's sons, would remark, "He is performing wonders in Petersburg right now."

This year was no different. The Tzemach Tzedek related all the goings-on in the capital and focused on certain ministers and their roles. In fact, he seemed more detailed than in other years, especially concerning Aleksey Suvorin, minister of Petersburg. The day of Rosh Hashana dawned, and throngs of Chasidim streamed to the Rebbe's shul. Again the Rebbe's prayers were permeated with emotion. After the morning prayer was completed and the Torah reading was finished, everyone prepared themselves for the primary mitzva (commandment) of the day - hearing the sounding of the shofar. A feeling of awe enveloped the large shul as the sons of the Tzemach Tzedek took their places around the bima, each in his designated place. The Tzemach Tzedek himself finished his preparations, readying himself to blow the shofar. His face burned brightly as he sang softly to himself, his eyes closed in deep concentration. Suddenly his voice resonated throughout the shul, "Woe! My heart! A Psalm..."

Panic gripped the congregation and tears flowed freely. Some evil decree prompted the Rebbe's unusual outburst, no doubt, and a great wailing filled the shul. Everyone's heart was open, raw and receptive. The congregation recited the Psalm seven times as required and the Rebbe began the shofar blasts...

Minister Suvorin studied his reflection in the mirror gracing the walls of the czar's antechamber. He was waiting for his scheduled appointment with His Majesty. In his hand was the document in which he had invested so much work. It concerned the great rabbi, the one they called the "Tzemach Tzedek."

It was intolerable that a rabbi should have all that power, what with all his followers spread across White Russia. His power lay in his choice of residence, a small village far away from prying eyes and government informers. No more. The rabbi would now be forced to move to either Petersburg or Kiev. His followers would think twice before visiting their rabbi in such a large city. They would be too easily followed, easily questioned, easily inspected. He had the official document in his hand now: all it needed was the czar's signature. Suvorin stared out the window. He smiled as he recalled his two new decrees. No smoking was allowed on city streets; it was untidy. No more meat would be sold within the city; no longer would the beautiful capital carry the smell of rotting flesh. He, Minister Suvorin, would make Petersburg the most beautiful capital in the world. A liveried servant entered the antechamber and bowed. "Minister Suvorin," he said. "His Majesty will see you now."

Suvorin followed the servant, beads of perspiration forming on his forehead. He entered the dazzling audience chamber and bowed low before the czar. The czar was in a foul mood. "You passed two decrees banning the sale of meat and use of cigarettes. The population is angry; the decrees are unbearable."

The czar tore the document out of the minister's hand and hurled it angrily on the floor. Suvorin turned white, bowed low and quickly left. The minister stood once again in the antechamber, his mind whirling. His dream had been shattered. Gone was his goal of restraining the great rabbi. For such was the accepted law: any document that had been thrown away by the czar was automatically negated and it was illegal to present the request again. The rabbi would stay in the village of Lubavitch after all.

Far away in the town of Lubavitch, the Tzemach Tzedek finished sounding the shofar. He returned to his place, and the congregation resumed their prayers.



THIS ISSUE, EXCLUSIVE INTERVIEW!
A FEW WORDS WITH...
ARI GOLDWAG



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PARSHA QUESTION By: Gavriel Grodka

Which body of water was Moshe told he would not cross?

Stay tuned for the answer in the next Community Corner issue

Answer to last weeks parsha question:

Q. Which shevatim inherited the land of Sichon and Og?

A. Reuven, Gad, and half of Manasheh.

MEGA VORT By: Yoel Megadesh



Parshas Nitzavim.Perek 29. Pasuk 9
"Atem Nitzavim Hayom... Meichotev Etzecha Ad Shoev Meimecha."

On the simple level, the pasuk is saying: Everyone is standing here today — from the woodchoppers to the water-drawers.

But the Medrash says "Hayom" is a hint to Rosh Hashanah.

If so, why mention wood and water specifically?

Because Chazal teach us two dates:

The 15th of Av is when they stopped chopping wood for the Mizbeach.And Hoshana Rabbah is the last day of the water libations — Nisuch HaMayim.

So the pasuk is giving us the entire window of Teshuvah in code:

"Meichotev Etzecha" — From the time they stopped chopping wood (Tu B'Av)

"Ad Shoev Meimecha" — Until the water-drawers (Hoshana Rabbah)

You are standing today on Rosh Hashanah, but your chance began before, and your chance continues after. Start early. You still have time until the last drop of water is poured.

(Siach HaParsha)

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